Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

762
-82 -9.72%
Sep 22nd, 2021

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

981
-91.00 -8.49%
Sep 22nd, 2021

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

518
-61 -10.54%
Sep 22nd, 2021

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

112.75
-0.30 -0.27%
Sep 22nd, 2021

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

131.15
-0.35 -0.27%
Sep 22nd, 2021

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

1030
-195 -15.92%
Week Ending Sep 17th, 2021

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2201 (Jan) RMB/t (3pm close)

668.50
39.50 6.28%
Sep 22nd, 2021 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
October 21 USD/dmt

107.20
13.95 14.96%
Sep 22nd, 2021 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2201 (Jan) RMB/t

5656
178 3.25%
Sep 22nd, 2021 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

36.67
1.26 3.56%
Sep 21st, 2021

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

18.07
1.10 6.48%
Sep 21st, 2021

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

5670
140 2.53%
Week Ending Sep 17th, 2021

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

129.29
-0.33 -0.25%
Week Ending Sep 17th, 2021

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

16.44
-0.45 -2.66%
Week Ending Sep 17th, 2021

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

5760
-110 -1.87%
Week Ending Sep 17th, 2021

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Sep 22nd, 2021		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	762	-82	-9.7%	981	1276	762	1680	109.14	-12.49	-10.3%	141.96	185.62	109.14	247.30
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	518	-61	-10.5%	673	1045	518	1421	73.66	-9.37	-11.3%	97.12	152.88	73.66	210.83
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	981	-91	-8.5%	1207	1483	950	1894	141.70	-13.91	-8.9%	175.70	216.32	130.19	278.61

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Sep 22nd, 2021		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	112.75	-0.30	-0.27%	131.90	180.55	112.75	230.50
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	131.15	-0.35	-0.27%	152.02	208.64	129.60	262.95

MARKET COMMENTARY

DCE iron ore futures market picked up quickly today, with warming transactions in the physical port stock market. PBF was closed at 705-710yuan/mt in Shandong market, with price hike of 5-20yuan/mt over that before the Mid-Autumn Festival holiday. And that in Tangshan market was concluded at 740-750yuan/mt, basically flat over that before the Mid-Autumn Festival holiday. Some steel mills say the cost performance for low grade ore and concentrates increased compared with the mainstream medium ore products, their demands for low grade ore increased, which caused recent shrinking price spread between mainstream medium and low grade ore products. Traders lack intentions to hold prices firm as some steel mills showed little willingness to restock before the upcoming National Day holiday.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Sep 17th, 2021		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-oW	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	1030	-195	-15.9%	1178	1539	886	1868	143.14	-27.86	-16.29%	164.24	214.40	118.00	262.00

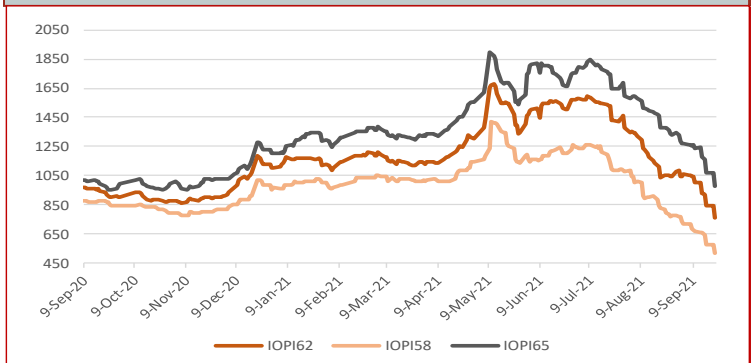
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Sep 17th, 2021				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1080	-6.1%	779	1645	167.52	-5.91%	110.31	255.69
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1315	-2.6%	780	1630	203.97	-2.41%	110.51	251.57
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	1010	-3.8%	620	1310	156.66	-3.63%	87.40	202.32
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1110	-7.5%	865	1752	172.18	-7.33%	122.55	272.32

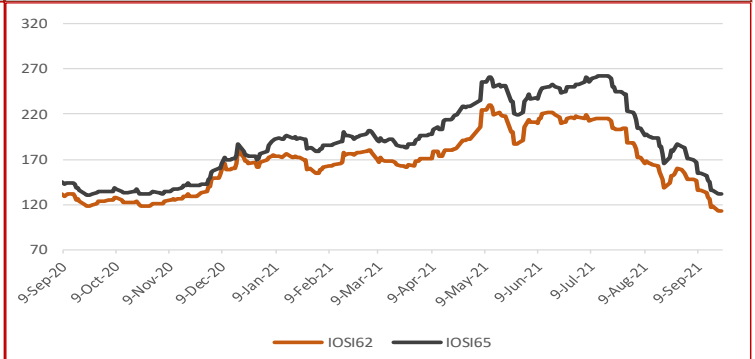
Week Ending Sep 17th, 2021	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	1141.49	-2.54%	706.36	1511.22

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 6.4934 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD 6.5044

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Sep 22nd, 2021		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	1511	1524	1519	1174	981	1258	1276	221.74	224.01	221.54	170.18	141.96	182.85	185.62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	1267	1199	1186	894	673	951	1045	187.31	177.34	173.94	130.00	97.12	138.73	152.88
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	1693	1756	1750	1466	1207	1511	1483	249.00	258.78	255.79	213.59	216.32	220.45	216.32

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Sep 22nd, 2021		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	208.38	213.90	211.65	162.80	131.90	171.96	180.55
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	241.08	244.31	254.36	192.73	152.02	203.81	208.64

FREIGHT RATES

Sep 21st, 2021		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	18.07	1.10	6.48%	3.57	16.77
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	36.67	1.26	3.56%	6.70	36.40

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Sep 17th, 2021		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	1665	1735	1816	1409	1178	1521	1539	234.20	245.23	254.64	196.49	164.24	212.64	214.40

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Sep 22nd, 2021		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-244	-32.02%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	219	28.74%

Sep 22nd, 2021		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	18.40	16.32%

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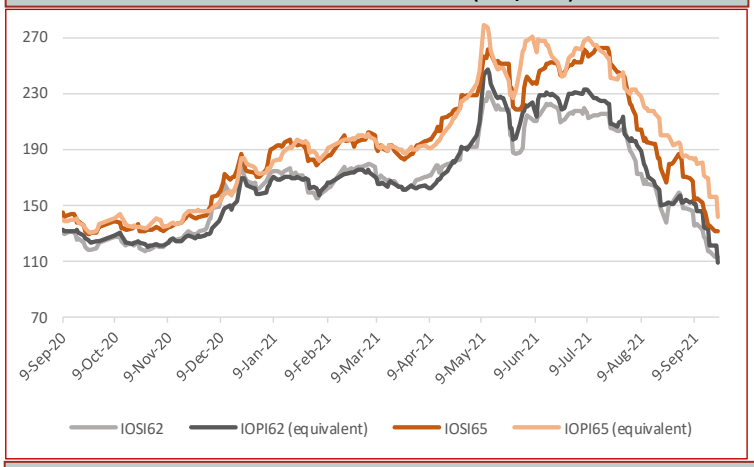
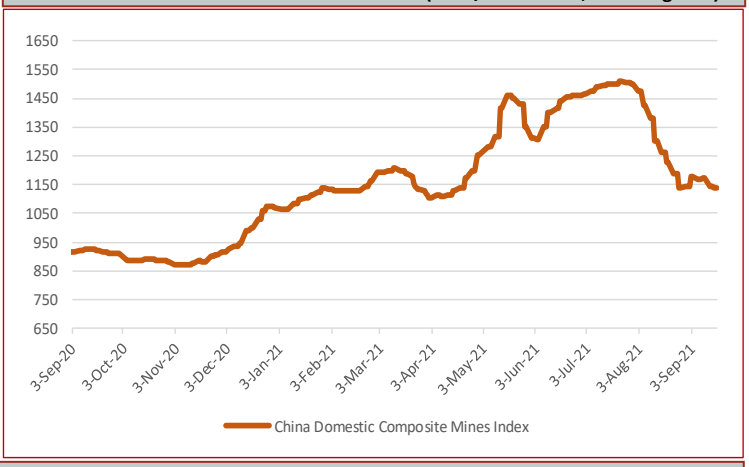
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)



IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Sep 22nd, 2021	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	716	-81	-46
SIMEC Fines	711	-84	-51
PB Fines	732	-81	-30
Newman Fines	775	-82	13
MAC Fines	716	-82	-46
Jimblebar Blended Fines	657	-81	-105
Carajas Fines	967	-91	205
Brazilian SSF	791	-91	29
Brazilian Blend Fines	779	-85	17
RTX Fines	641	-81	-121
West Pilbara Fines	703	-82	-59

Sep 22nd, 2021	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	108.25	-0.30	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	104.75	-0.30	-8.00
PB Fines	111.50	-0.30	-1.25
Newman Fines	112.65	-0.30	-0.10
MAC Fines	108.65	-0.30	-4.10
Jimblebar Blended Fines	102.00	-0.30	-10.75
Carajas Fines	142.30	-0.30	29.55
Brazilian SSF	116.50	-0.30	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	118.15	-0.30	5.40
RTX Fines	102.65	-0.30	-10.10
West Pilbara Fines	107.00	-0.30	-5.75

Sep 22nd, 2021	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	517	-61	-1
FMG Blended Fines	522	-62	4
Robe River	521	-62	3
Western Fines	527	-62	9
Atlas Fines	518	-61	0
Yandi	515	-60	-3

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)			
	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	26.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	38.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	38.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	38.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	11.00	2.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	20.00	-5.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	44.00	-2.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	69.00	-2.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	30.00	5.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	40.00	-2.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade	8.00	2.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	13.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	13.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)			
	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	4.50	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	3.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	3.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	3.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	0.50	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	3.00	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	3.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	9.50	0.25
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	0.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	0.25	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-75.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-95.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-40.00	10.00	Jingtang	-40.00	10.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-95.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-40.00	10.00

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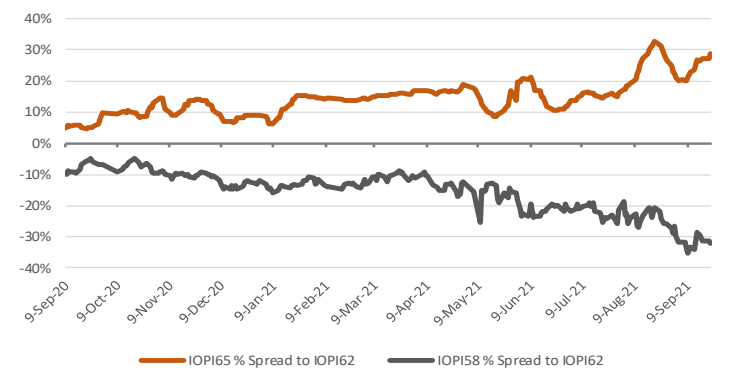
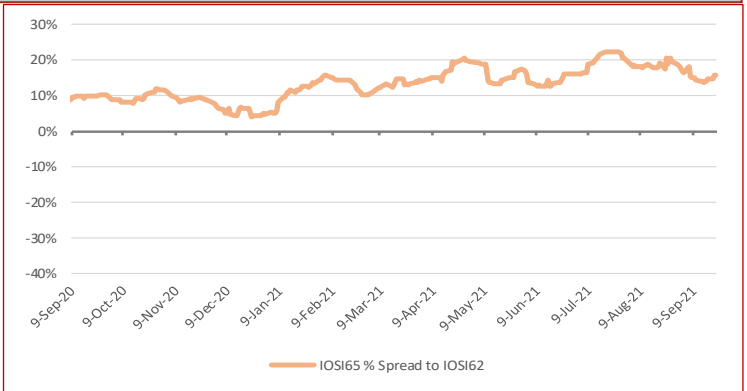
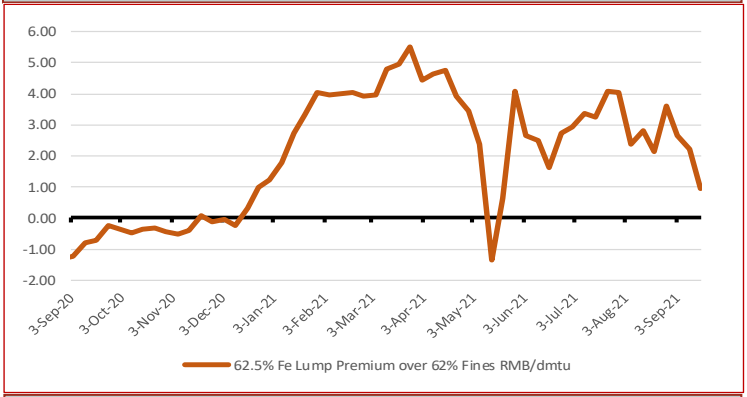
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

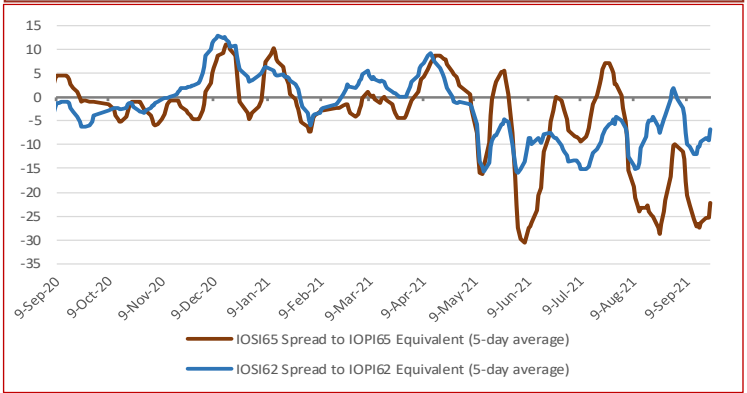




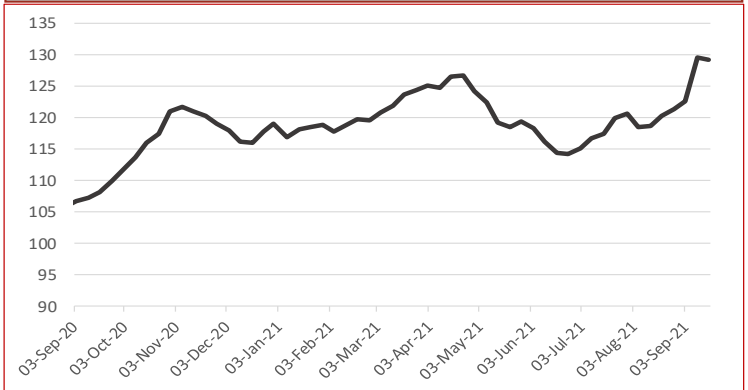
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



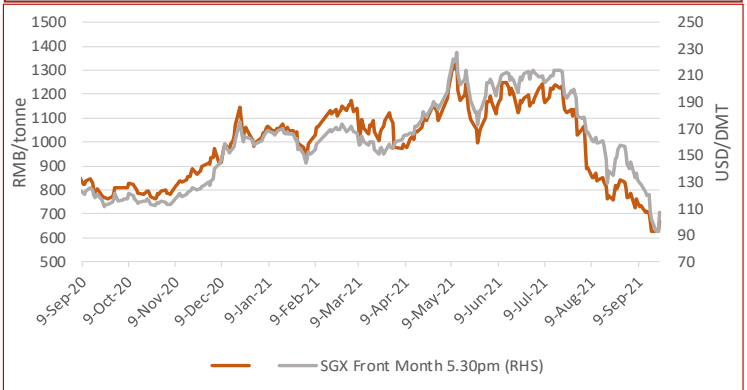
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

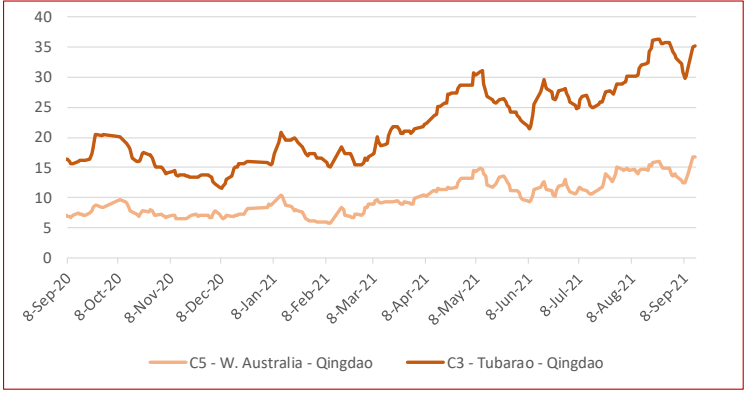
Week Ending Sep 17th, 2021

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	16.38	0.80%	12.26	19.20
Qingdao	21.29	4.16%	9.41	21.29
Caofeidian	12.09	-1.14%	12.09	16.25
Tianjin	10.28	-2.37%	7.14	11.28
Rizhao	12.23	1.58%	9.44	14.22
Total (35 Ports)	129.29	-0.25%	98.80	129.62

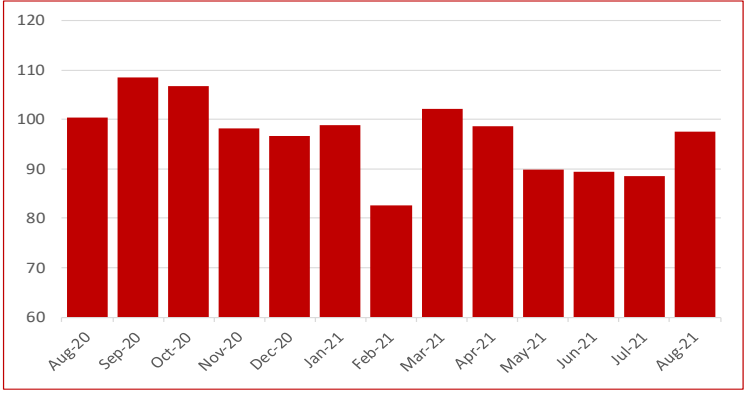
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Sep 22nd, 3pm close			Sep 22nd, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2201	Change	Change %	Oct. 21	Change	Change %
Closing Price	668.50	39.50	6.28%	107.20	13.95	14.96%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	77.49	-10.73	-12.16%	3.36	3.00	816.77%
Open positions ('000 lots)	58.07	-3.88	-6.27%	17.59	0.04	0.20%
Day Low	606.0	-22.50	-3.58%	94.25	1.95	2.11%
Day High	671.5	1.50	0.22%	108.20	11.90	12.36%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2021/9/17	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	5,670	140	2.53%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	6,050	170	2.89%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	5,760	-110	-1.87%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	6,500	0	0.00%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	5,670	-10	-0.18%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	6,760	-20	-0.29%
Colour Coated Plate	8,850	50	0.57%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

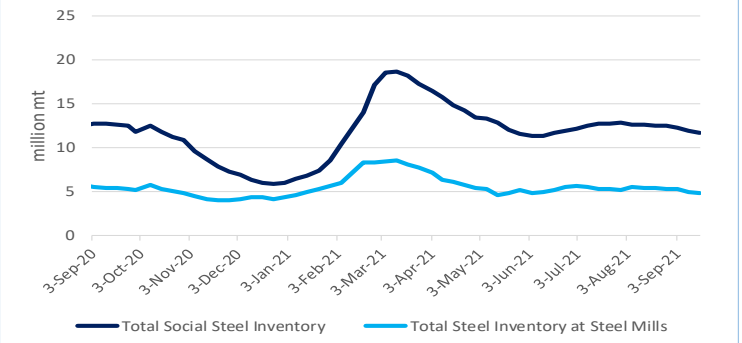
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	117.35	-18	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	4,210	200	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	3,570	-50	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	4,422	-110	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	4,684	-96	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	1,084	302	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	4,702	-110	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	1,049	0	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

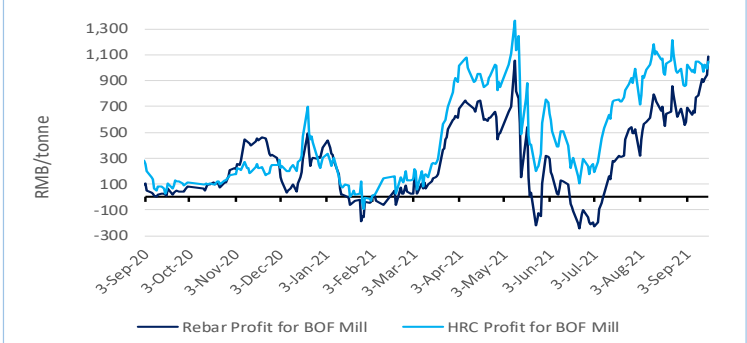
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

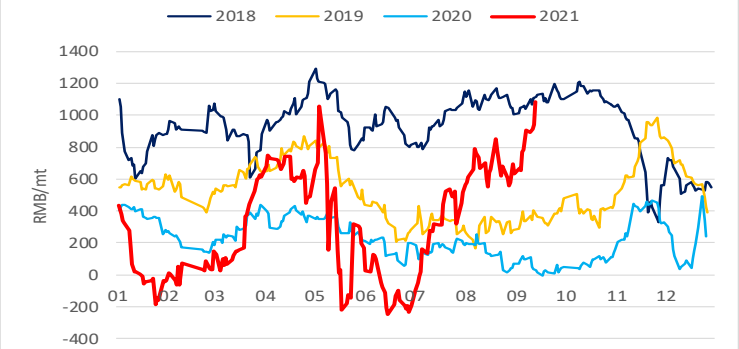
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



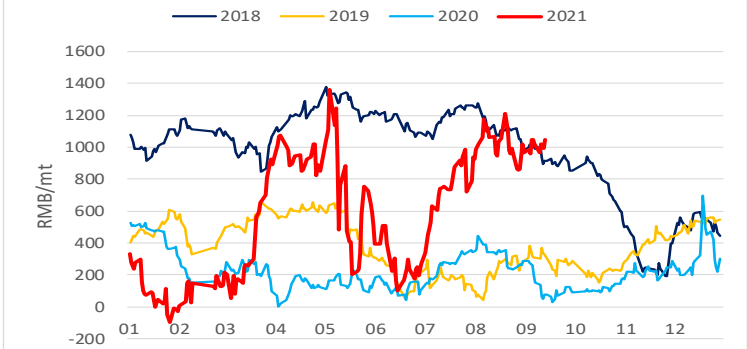
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



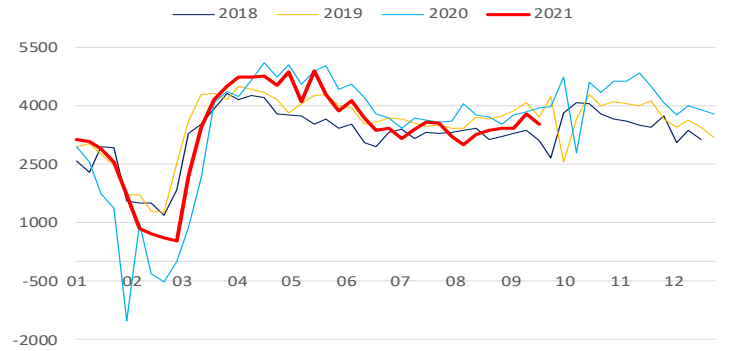
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



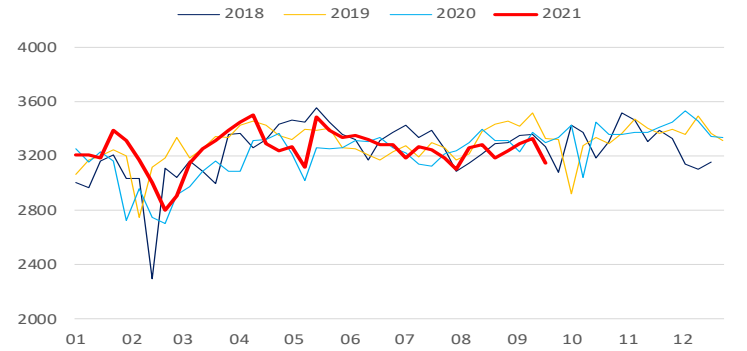
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



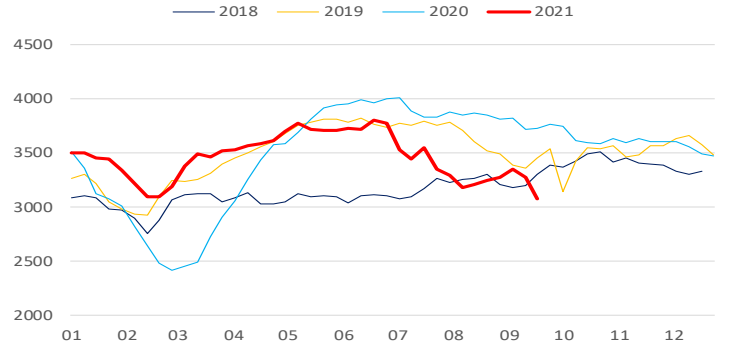
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



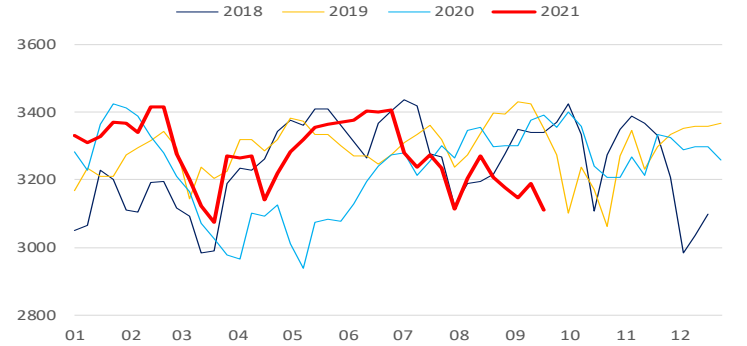
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Sep 22nd, 2021	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Sep 22nd, 2021	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.40%	0.090%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.70%	0.080%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.00%	4.50%	0.120%	8.00%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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